UNIT 2: KNOW YOURSELF

TOPIC 2: OCCUPATIONAL INTERESTS

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Participate in a detailed, online career assessment that will focus on interest areas and specific careers
- Identify their career interests
- Learn more about "Occupation Types" and see which groupings seem to match their interests most strongly
- Understand the Student Career Portfolio process that they will complete during the course of the program

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Have their results from an online career interest assessment (O*NET Interest Profiler), which they can use to narrow down career clusters/areas of interest, and discover occupations that match their profile
- Receive their portfolio and portfolio checklist, and enter the first component (O*NET Interest Profiler results) both electronically and in their Student Career Portfolio

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objectives:
- To help students understand how knowing their interests can be a tool to finding a satisfying career.
- To understand that their portfolios will be a valuable career resource for them that they will add to during the course of the program.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Portfolio binders with labeled clear sleeves for each assignment, flash drives

Begin by handing out the binder portfolios, portfolio checklists, and flash drives to each student. Ask if anyone might know what a portfolio does, or what it looks like. Explain that portfolios are a great way to capture and keep important career information, which they can refer to when interviewing for a job. Remind them there will be a similar online version at their Mass CIS My Portfolio site. Reassure students that there will be lots of help and guidance available to them in order to complete their portfolio, and that it will be filled with "real world" information and examples that will help them join, remain, and advance in the workforce. Tell students they should bring their binder and flash drive to class every session.

Ask the students to name some people they know who seem to really like their job. Then ask why they think that is so (money, hours, challenging, interesting, etc.). Ask what interests the people named have that might relate to their job and happiness with their occupation. Explain that knowing your interests while searching for occupations can help ensure success and satisfaction on the job. If comfortable, students can share an interest they have with the group (such as music, dogs, computers, cars, etc.), or the instructor can provide some general interest areas, and the class can brainstorm careers that might support that interest.

Writing/Reflection/Assessment

Objective: Students will learn more about "Occupation Types" and see which groupings seem to match their interests most strongly.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Interest Assessments"** (sheets 1-4) for everyone in the class, pens/pencils

Explain to students that careers are often grouped into "types" or "clusters" that revolve around a unifying interest (Health Care, Agriculture, Information Technology, etc.). Have everyone fill out the quick "Interest Inventory" and add up their scores to see which occupational type they fall under. Ask students to circle three specific careers of interest under the cluster they scored the highest.

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objectives:
- Students will participate in a detailed, online career assessment, that will help students focus on interest areas and specific careers.
- To include this information in paper, electronic, and online portfolios in their portfolios.

Time: 25 minutes

Materials: Computers with internet connection, index cards with names and passwords, pens/pencils, printer to print out individual results for portfolio, flash drives, portfolio binders

Have students log onto **Mass CIS** and click on the **"O*Net Interest Profiler,"** under the Assessment Tools heading in the lower left corner. The Assessment is self-explanatory, but be available for questions or clarifications. After students have completed the assessment and explored related jobs, have them save their results to their **Mass CIS** portfolio and their flash drive, and print the results for their paper portfolio.

Student Career Portfolio Checklist

A Student Career Portfolio could contain the following items in both hard copy and electronically (on a flash drive).

Student Career Portfolio Contents:

- ☐ Results of (**Mass CIS**) O*NET Interest Profiler
- ☐ Results of (**Mass CIS**) O*NET Work Importance Locator
- ☐ Results of (**Mass CIS**) SKILLS Work Skills Assessment
- ☐ Writing Sample
- ☐ Job Research Sheet
- ☐ Career Research Sheet
- ☐ Completed Job Application
- ☐ E-mail Job Inquiry
- ☐ Resume
- ☐ Two Cover Letters for Resume
- ☐ Two Letters of Reference
- ☐ Thank You Letter for Post-Interview
- ☐ Successful Practice Interview
- ☐ Long Term Goal Sheet

INTEREST INVENTORY

Write the number on each line that rates how much you would enjoy doing each activity. You can choose any number between 0 and 10.

0= No
3= I don't think so
5= Not sure
7= I might like it
10= Yes!

1. Would you enjoy?
   __a. preparing food in a restaurant
   __b. driving a forklift
   __c. working in a hospital
   __d. performing in front of others
   __e. installing steel beams in buildings
   __f. typing letters
   __g. working with children

2. Would you enjoy?
   __a. working in a grocery store
   __b. being an inspector
   __c. working in a nursing home
   __d. arranging plants
   __e. doing remodeling
   __f. filing letters and office forms
   __g. helping the elderly

3. Would you enjoy?
   __a. dusting, cleaning, polishing
   __b. doing welding
   __c. working in a lab
   __d. singing, reading, playing music
   __e. being a plumber or electrician
   __f. working with books and records
   __g. teaching others

4. Would you enjoy?
   __a. cutting and styling other people's hair
   __b. being a general laborer
   __c. taking x-rays
   __d. working with flowers
   __e. doing carpentry or bricklaying
   __f. opening and sorting mail
   __g. helping others with their problems

5. Would you enjoy?
   __a. being an automobile mechanic
   __b. supervising other working persons
   __c. working with sick people
   __d. working with crafts
   __e. building homes
   __f. answering phones
   __g. helping people who are in trouble

6. Would you enjoy?
   __a. installing carpet
   __b. operating factory machines
   __c. working with a dentist
   __d. doing interior decorating
   __e. driving a bulldozer
   __f. working with money
   __g. doing things for other people

Now put the numbers you have written in these blanks and then add them together.

	TOTAL
1a__ + 2a__ +3a__ +4a__ +5a__ +6a__ =	A____Service occupations
1b__ +2b__ +3b__ +4b__ +5b__ +6b__ =	B____Factory occupations
1c__ +2c__ +3c__ +4c__ +5c__ +6c__ =	C____Health occupations
1d__ +2d__ +3d__ +4d__ +5d__ +6d__ =	D____Creative occupations
1e__ +2e__ +3e__ +4e__ +5e__ +6e__=	E_____Building and trades
1f__ +2f__ +3f__ +4f__ +5f__ +6f__=	F_____Clerical occupations
1g__ +2g__ +3g__ +4g__ +5g__ +6g__=	G_____Caring and helping occupations

The number you put in each **TOTAL** blank is your score for that type of occupation. The higher your score the better you will like that type of work. Look at the next page for some of the jobs you might find in each type of work.

OCCUPATIONS

A. Service Occupations

Aircraft flight attendant
Air traffic controller
Barber
Bartender
Beautician
Cook/chef
Correction officer
Cosmetologist
Custodian
Food counter worker
Food service management
Forester
Garbage collector
Guard
Maid
Meatcutter
Mechanic
Police officer
Postal mail carrier
Waiter/waitress
Warehouse worker

B. Factory Occupations

Assembler
Equipment operator
Inspector
Laborer
Machine tool operator
Machinist
Photograph process worker
Printing press operator
Supervisor
Tool/die maker
Welder

C. Health Occupations

Dental assistant
Dental hygienist
Dentist
Dietitian
Health administrator
Home health care worker
Medical lab worker
Nurse
Pharmacist
Physical therapist
Physician
Respiratory therapist
Technician
Veterinarian

D. Creative Occupations

Artist
Florist
Graphic arts
Interior decorator
Journalist/reporter
Musician
Photographer
Radio/TV announcer
Recreation
Writer

E. Building and Trades

Bricklayer
Carpenter
Construction laborer
Electrician
Engineer
Heavy equipment operator
Painter
Plumber
Roofer

F. **Clerical Occupations**

Accountant
Cashier
Clerk
Collection worker
Computer operator
Computer programmer
Insurance representative
Keyboard operator
Librarian
Library assistant
Marketing
Receptionist
Secretary
Stenographer
Telephone operator
Typist

G. **Caring and Helping Occupations**

Child care worker
Coach
Counselor/therapist
Psychologist
Social worker
Teacher
Bank manager
Bank teller
Bookkeeper